David Wishart



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Profile

Highly motivated career changer with over a decade of experience as a conductor, pianist, and composer. From my extensive experience working at the highest levels of classical music, I bring leadership experience, organizational talent, as well as excellent teamwork and communication skills with me. I have been pursuing independent study in data analysis and software development, with the goal of making a concrete contribution to social progress and sustainability.

Experience

Deutsche Oper Berlin

Musical assistant & director | since 2019

- Musical Director – *Bär*in* (2023, world premiere)
  Overall responsibility for musical quality. Conductor and pianist in performances. Coordination with composer, artistic, and technical teams.
- Musical Director – *Extended Version: The Flying Dutchman* (2023)
  Piano accompaniment and organizational responsibility for a 12-hour long performance event. Collaboration with international artists and technical teams.
- Répétiteur (rehearsal pianist) – *Written on Skin* (2024)
  Piano accompaniment of rehearsals for a highly complex modern opera under internationally renowned conductor Marc Albrecht. Selected to play in the piano dress rehearsal on the main stage due to excellent work in rehearsals..
- Souffleur (Prompter) – *Götterdämmerung* & *Der Schatzgräber* (2026)
  Support for the singers through whispering and singing prompts in rehearsals and performances. Highly concentrated teamwork in precise coordination with the conductor. Anticipatory crisis management under extreme, moment-to-moment time pressure.

Theater Vorpommern

Répétiteur & conductor | 2020 – 2025

- Elected Ensemble Speaker (2023-25)
  Communication and conflict mediation between the music theater ensemble and management. Participation in selection processes for management positions. Involvement in the yearly schedule and rehearsal plan for the entire theater.

- Musical Director and Arranger
  Collaborative development of music theater pieces together with directors, and dramaturges. Conducting and piano accompaniment in performances. Organization and management of rehearsals. Creative arrangements of existing music and the production of professional sheet music. Interviews and public speaking in German during and before performances.
- Pianist & Coach
  Diverse contributions to 5-6 Productions each season. Piano accompaniment in rehearsals and performances. Coaching (musical and diction in German, English, Italian and French) of singers. High resilience and teamwork skills.

Self-employed

Musician & Teacher | since 2014

- Musical Director
  Conducting as well as rehearsal planning and management for various ensembles in the free scene in Germany (including Skycradle Hamburg, Passaggio Oper, Cultura Immanuel, Alltagsoper).
- Musical Assistant
  Piano accompaniment of rehearsals and performances. Coaching and organizational preparation. (including with Opera de Tenerife, Indemini Festival Switzerland, Softly Loud Consulting, The Embassy Singers).
- Vocal Coach & Piano Teacher
  Empathetic and supportive lessons for singers and pianists of all ages and abilities. Substitute piano teacher at Joseph-Schmidt Music School and Music School Behm, Bertheau & Morgenstern.
- Self-management
  Independent Administration of my freelance business. Scheduling, marketing, web design, invoicing and contract management.

Education

MMus – Composition

University of Manchester | 2012 – 2014

MusB(Hons) – Music

University of Manchester | 2009 – 2012

Certificates

- Codecademy | Full-Stack Career Path | ongoing
- Google | Data Analytics Professional Certificate | 2026
- ITTT | TEFL (Teaching English as a Foreign Language) Certificate | 2015

Skills

Languages: English (native), German (fluent, C1), Italian & French (basic)

IT: MS Office, Google Workspace, Sibelius, HTML/CSS/JavaScript/Python/SQL

Organization & Communication: Structured style, coordination of complex processes/events. High resilience and reliability. Quick adaption to new systems. Leadership, teamwork, communication.